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*Ancient water in a system
The cycle of ice, of water, of gas
expanding, retracting
Stored in a beautiful white mass*

~~~

*Mountainous bunches hanging in the sky  
An eagle, an angel, a bird passes by*

~~~

*A dolphin, a turtle, a fly, a feather
Let's go spot clouds together*

*

Yarn & Notions

PLEASE READ: Due to the construction, this top use one cake of whirl but also a few balls of Catona. There have been several people that have asked me if it is possible to use only a cake of whirl, but it will not give you the same effect and you also might not have enough yarn to make a whole top. Nowadays there are also little single colored balls, named Whirlette, you can use these instead of Catona. If you use Whirlette, you can do the whole top with the 3,5mm hook.

Scheepjes Catona in colorway 105 (100% cotton, 125 meters/50 grams):

S/M: 2 balls

L/XL: 3 balls

AND

Scheepjes Whirl in colorway 'Blueberry Bam Bam' (60% cotton/40% acrylic, 1000 meters/215-225 grams):

All sizes: 1 cake

- 3 and 3,5 mm hook or size to obtain gauge

- Darning needle, thread clippers and stitch markers

If you don't have a retailer nearby, please consider buying your Scheepjes yarn via one of the following links. It will give me a small commission, but it won't cost you anything extra: [Knotty House](#), [Wool Warehouse](#), [Black Sheep Wools](#) or [Deramores](#)

Gauge & Sizes

Use a 3,5mm hook with Whirl and a 3mm hook for the Catona: 10x10 cm (4x4") = 12 rows x 18 dc unblocked

- The top comes in sizes S/M and L/XL (the model is a size S and is wearing size S/M):

* Body circumference: 118cm/47.2" (138cm/55.2")

* Shoulder piece width: 49cm/19.3" (59cm/23.2")

* Shoulder piece height: 37cm/14.6" (43cm/16.9")

- The length is up to you. I made the top in S/M and used 178 grams of Whirl, which gave me a length of 35 cm/14" measured from the armhole (unblocked). I could have made this into a tunic with the remaining yarn I had.

Stitches & Abbreviations (US terms)

sl st slip stitch

ch chain

ch-sp chain space

sk skip

sc single crochet

hdc half double crochet

dc double crochet

tr treble

puff-st puff stitch: [yo, insert hook in stitch and pull up loop] 5 times total (11 loops on hook), yo and pull through all loops, close with ch1

st stitch

rep repeat

... repeat the instructions between asterisks up to where the pattern indicates

[...] work the instructions between brackets for the total number of times indicated in the pattern

RS right side of your work

pic picture

Notes & tips

- *Construction: The whole top is constructed top-down and seamlessly, so there are very little ends to work away when you're done and you can decide on your own length.*
- *When you're working on the lace section, the first and last stitch can be harder to see; use markers for these stitches.*
- *The instructions and stitch counts for different sizes are given between parenthesis in this order: S/M (L/XL). If the instructions are the same, the numbers for L/XL are not given again. The turning chain doesn't count as a stitch, i.e. you always begin in the first st of the new row.*

The Pattern

Back shoulder piece

Setup: With 3,5 mm hook and Scheepjes Catona; ch92 (110).

R1 (RS) Switch to 3 mm hook; Starting from the second ch from hook; sc across, ch2 {doesn't count as a st throughout}, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) sc

R2-3 1 dc in each st across, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

R4 1 hdc in each dc across, ch1, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) hdc

Cumulus clouds

R5 Switch to the 3,5 mm hook; 1 sc in first st, *sk next 2 st, 5 dc in next st {cloud made}, sk next 2 st, 1 sc in next st* rep between * * to end, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 15 (18) clouds, 16 (19) sc

R6 1 hdc in first sc, *ch2, 1 sc in middle dc of cloud, ch2, 1 hdc in next sc* rep between * * to end, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 15 (18) sc, 16 (19) hdc, 30 (36) ch-sp

R7 *Note: the loop of the hdc is sometimes a bit awkward to work into. It is situated after the post of the stitch.*

3 dc in first hdc, *1 sc in next sc, 5 dc in next hdc* rep between * * until the last sc and hdc, 1 sc in next sc, 3 dc in last hdc, ch1, turn. **Stitch count:** 14 (17) clouds, 2 x 3dc clouds, 15 (18) sc

R8 1 sc in first dc, *ch2, 1 hdc in next sc, ch2, 1 sc in middle dc of cloud* rep between * * to the last sc and the last 3dc-cloud, ch2, 1 hdc in next sc, ch2, 1 sc in last dc of the 3dc-cloud, ch1, turn. **Stitch count:** 16 (19) sc, 15 (18) hdc, 30 (36) ch-sp

R9 1 sc in first sc, *5 dc in next hdc, 1 sc in next sc* rep between * * to end, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 15 (18) clouds, 16 (19) sc

S/M: R10-18: rep R6-9 two more times. After that, rep R6 once more. {you will have 7 rows with clouds}

L/XL: R10-22: rep R6-9 three more times. After that, rep R6 once more. {you will have 9 rows with clouds}

R19 (S/M) or R23 (L/XL) Switch to the 3 mm hook; 1 dc in first hdc, *2 dc in next ch2-sp, 1 dc in next sc, 2 dc in next ch2-sp, 1 dc in next hdc* rep between * * to end, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

R20 (S/M) or R24 (L/XL) 1 dc in each dc across, ch1, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

Back shoulder and neck shaping

R21 (S/M) or R25 (L/XL) 1 sc in next 5 (7) dc, 1 hdc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 dc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 tr in next 5 (7) dc, ch1 {point of first shoulder made}, 1 dc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 hdc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 sc in next 31 (33) dc, 1 hdc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 dc in next 5 (6) dc, ch1 {point of second shoulder made}, 1 tr in next 5 (7) dc, 1 dc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 hdc in next 5 (6) dc, 1 sc in last 5 (7) dc, ch1, turn.

Stitch count: 41 (47) sc, 20 (24) hdc, 20 (24) dc, 10 (14) tr, 2 x ch1-sp

Front shoulder and neck shaping

Note: The neck opening is made with a long chain, make sure not to twist it while connecting it to the second shoulder. If you know yourself to be a tight chainer, use a bigger hook.

R22 (S/M) or R26 (L/XL) 1 sc in next 5 (7) st, 1 hdc in next 4 (5) st, 1 dc in next 4 (5) st, 1 tr in next 7 (9) st, chain 51 (57), sk the next 51 (57) st, 1 tr in next 7 (9) st {*this connects the chain to the second shoulder*}, 1 dc in next 4 (5) st, 1 hdc in next 4 (5) st, 1 sc in last 5 (7) st, ch2, turn.

Stitch count: 10 (14) sc, 8 (10) hdc, 8 (10) dc, 14 (18) tr, 51 (57) chains

R23 (S/M) or R27 (L/XL) 1 dc in next 20 (26) st, 1 dc in each of the next 51 (57) chains, 1 dc in last 20 (26) st, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

R24 (S/M) or R28 (L/XL) 1 dc in each dc across, ch1, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

S/M: R25-38: rep R5-18, not forgetting to switch to the 3,5 mm hook.

L/XL: R29-46: rep R5-22, not forgetting to switch to the 3,5 mm hook.

R39 (S/M) or R47 (L/XL) Switch to 3 mm hook; 1 hdc in first st, *2 hdc in next ch2-sp, 1 hdc in next st, 2 hdc in next ch2-sp, 1 hdc in next st* rep between * * to end, ch2, turn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) hdc

R40-41 (S/M) or R48-49 (L/XL) 1 dc in each hdc across, ch2, turn. {*At the end of R41 (S/M) or R49 (L/XL), ch1 instead of 2*}. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) dc

R42 (S/M) or R50 (L/XL) 1 sc in each dc across, cut yarn. **Stitch count:** 91 (109) sc

Slip stitch with a 3,5mm hook around the neckline, so it won't lose its shape. Make sure to not make these slip stitches too tight! Work away the ends and wetblock the shoulder piece to the following dimensions {*really stretching it to open up the lace*}: S/M: 49 cm/19.3" wide and 37 cm/14.6" high. L/XL: 59 cm/23.2" wide and 43 cm/16.9" high

Sleeves

Notes:

- The 3,5 mm hook and Whirl yarn is used for the rest of the pattern
- For this part, up to R11, you work in the round in spirals, so there's no slip stitching and chaining to close the round; you'll just work continuously.
- The stitches that are picked up at the sides of the shoulder piece will form short sleeves.
- After R1 there can be some slight puckering in the corners, but this will be resolved with blocking.

R1 (RS) Switch to the 3,5 mm hook and Whirl yarn; begin with the right side facing you, start in the first sc of the front of the shoulder piece, using a standing sc (or sl st, ch1, 1 sc); 1 sc in each of next 91 (109) sc, ch1, pm {= *place marker*} in ch1, pick up 60 (72) sc along the side of the shoulder piece, ch1, pm in ch1, 1 sc in each of next 91 (109) chains of the foundation chain, ch1, pm in ch1, pick up 60 (72) sc along the side of the shoulder piece, ch1, pm in ch1. **Stitch count:** 302 (362) sc, 4 x ch1

Note: The increases that are made count towards the body, not the sleeves, so when you count your stitches for the front and back, you count from marker to marker and when you count for the sleeves, you count the stitches in between the markers.

R2 *1sc in each of next 91 (109) sc, 1 sc in ch1, pm in sc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) sc, 1 dc in next 10 (12) sc, 1 tr in next 20 (24) sc, 1 dc in next 10 (12) sc, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) sc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 1 sc in ch1, pm in sc* rep between * * 1 more time **Stitch count:** back/front: 93 (111) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 20 (24) dc, 20 (24) tr

R3 *1 sc in each sc to marker, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in second made sc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) hdc, 1 dc in next 10 (12) dc, [1 tr in next tr, 2 tr in next tr] 10 (12) times total, 1 dc in next 10 (12) dc, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) hdc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in first made sc* rep between * * 1 more time. **Stitch count:** back/front: 95 (113) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 20 (24) dc, 30 (36) tr

R4 *1 sc in each sc to marker, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in second made sc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) hdc, 1 dc in next 50 (60) st, 1 hdc in next 5 (7) hdc, 1 sc in next 5 sc, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in first made sc* rep between * * 1 more time. **Stitch count:** back/front: 97 (115) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 50 (60) dc

R5-7: rep R4 three times more

Stitch count R5: Back/front: 99 (117) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 50 (60) dc

Stitch count R6: Back/front: 101 (119) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 50 (60) dc

Stitch count R7: Back/front: 103 (121) sc - Per sleeve: 10 sc, 10 (14) hdc, 50 (60) dc

R8 *1 sc in each sc to marker, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in second made sc, [1 sc in next st, ch1, sk next st] 3 times total, [1 hdc in next st, ch1, sk next st] 2 (3) times total, [1 dc in next st, ch1, sk next st] 25 (30) times total, [1 hdc in next st, ch1, sk next st] 3 (4) times total, [1 sc in next st, ch1, sk next st] 2 times total, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in first made sc* rep between * * 1 more time. **Stitch count:** Back/front: 105 (123) sc - Per sleeve: 5 sc, 5 (7) hdc, 25 (30) dc, 35 (42) ch1-sp

R9 *1 sc in each sc to marker, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in second made sc, sk next sc, 2 sc in next 2 ch-sp, 2 hdc in next 3 (4) ch-sp, 2 dc in next 25 (30) ch-sp, 2 hdc in next 3 (4) ch-sp, 2 sc in next 2 ch-sp, 2 sc in marked sc, pm in first made sc* rep between * * 1 more time. **Stitch count:** Back/front: 107 (125) sc - Per sleeve: 8 sc, 12 (16) hdc, 50 (60) dc

Body

Cirrocumulus clouds

R10 1 sc in each sc to marker, 1 sc in marked sc, ch4, sk all the stitches of the sleeve, connect to the back of the shoulder piece with 1 sc in next marked sc, 1 sc in each sc to marker, 1 sc in marked sc, ch4, sk all the stitches of the sleeve, connect to the front of the shoulder piece with 1 sc in last marked sc. Remove all markers. **Stitch count:** Back/front: 107 (125) sc, 2 x ch4

Note: From here on you will not work in spirals anymore. The ch1 is used to start a sc, hdc and dc. It does not count as a st, so you always work in the first st of the round. You are free to use any other method of beginning a new round.

R11 *1 sc in each sc across, 1 sc in each of next 4 chains* rep between * * 1 more time, join the round with a sl st in first sc, ch1 *{doesn't count as a st, here and throughout}*. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) sc

R12 *1 sc in next 5 sc, puff-st in next sc* rep between * * around, sl st in first sc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 185 (215) sc, 37 (43) puff-st

R13 *Note: don't forget to skip the ch1 of the puff.* 1 sc in each st around, sl st in first sc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) sc

R14 1 dc in each sc around, sl st in first dc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) dc

R15 1 sc in each st around, sl st in first sc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) sc

R16 1 sc in first 4 sc, *puff-st in next sc, 1 sc in next 5 sc* rep around, omitting the last 4 sc of the last repeat, sl st in first sc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 185 (215) sc, 37 (43) puff-st

R17 1 sc in each st around, sl st in first sc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) sc

R18-22: 1 dc in each st around, sl st in first st, ch1.

Cirrus clouds

R23 1 sc in first st, *ch2, sk next st, 1 dc in next st, ch1, sk next st, 1 dc in next st, ch2, sk next st, 1 sc in next st* rep between * * around, omitting the last sc of the last repeat, sl st in first sc, sl st in first ch-sp, ch2. **Stitch count:** 37 (43) sc, 74 (86) dc, 111 (129) ch-sp

R24 *2 dc in ch2-sp, 2 sc in next ch1-sp {*between the 2 dc*}, 2 dc in next ch2-sp* rep between * * around, sl st in first dc, ch2. **Stitch count:** 148 (172) dc, 74 (86) sc

R25-28: 1 dc in each st around, sl st in first dc, ch1. Stitch count: 222 (258) dc

More cumulus clouds

R29 1 sc in first dc, *ch1, sk next 2 dc, 5 dc in next dc {*cloud made*}, ch1, sk next 2 dc, 1 sc in next dc* rep between * * around, skipping the last sc on the last repeat, sl st in first sc, ch2. **Stitch count:** 37 (43) clouds, 37 (43) sc

R30 1 hdc in first sc, *ch2, 1 sc in middle dc of cloud, ch2, 1 hdc in next sc* rep between * * around, skipping the last hdc on the last repeat, sl st in first hdc, ch2. **Stitch count:** 37 (43) sc, 37 (43) hdc, 74 (86) ch2-sp

R31 3 dc in first hdc, *ch1, 1 sc in next sc, ch1, 5 dc in next hdc* rep between * * around, working 2 dc in the first hdc on the last repeat, sl st in first dc, ch1. **Stitch count:** 37 (43) clouds, 37 (43) sc

R32 1 sc in first dc, *ch2, 1 hdc in next sc, ch2, 1 sc in middle dc of cloud* rep between * * around, skipping the last sc on the last repeat, sl st in first sc, ch2. **Stitch count:** 37 (43) sc, 37 (43) hdc, 74 (86) ch2-sp

R33 1 dc in first sc, *2 dc in next ch2-sp, 1 dc in next hdc, 2 dc in next ch2-sp, 1 dc in next sc* rep between * * around, sl st in first dc, ch2. **Stitch count:** 222 (258) dc

R34-37: 1 dc in each st around, sl st in first dc, ch1. Stitch count: 222 (258) dc

Rep R23-37 until you reach the desired length or until you run out of whirl, ending with a few rounds of dc. {*I repeated R23-37 once more. After that I repeated R23 and 24 and ended with 2 rounds of dc*} Block to the measurements at the top of this page and weave in the remaining ends. Enjoy!